IMPULSE
LEARNING CENTER

LEVEL A2 · ELEMENTARY

Writing Book

Model texts, useful vocabulary with Uzbek translations, real-life writing tasks and IELTS-style opinion paragraphs in 12 units.

12 units | 24 writing tasks | 120 words & phrases | Model answers

UNIT 4.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK

Is it better to live in a city or in the countryside?

In my opinion | Firstly | On the other hand | To sum up

I think it is better to live in a city, especially for young people.

How to use this book

1. Read the model

Read the model text. Find the **highlighted phrases** and notice how the text is organised.

2. Learn the language

Study the **Language focus** and the **Words & phrases**, then do the practice.

3. Plan

Make short notes for each paragraph before you start writing.

4. Write and check

Write your text, then use the **Self-check** list. Compare with the model answers.

EACH UNIT HAS SEVEN PARTS

1 · Model text
A real example of the unit's text type.

2 · Language focus
One writing skill with examples.

3 · Words & phrases
Ten useful collocations with Uzbek.

4 · Practice
Use the new words in sentences.

5 · Plan
Notes for each paragraph.

6 · Writing task
A real-life task with lines to write on.

7 · IELTS-style task
An opinion paragraph with ideas and a plan.

A GOOD PARAGRAPH

Topic	In my opinion, it is important to learn a foreign language.
Support	Firstly, it gives you more job opportunities. For example, many companies want workers who speak English.
End	**To sum up, I believe everyone should learn at least one foreign language.**

AT THE BACK OF THE BOOK

Writing bank — useful phrases for every text type

Common mistakes — check before you finish

Answer key — practice exercises

Model answers — for every writing task

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UNIT 1

Your World

Text type: Informal email · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 1.1 · MODEL TEXT · INFORMAL EMAIL

Hi from Tashkent!

Hi Emma,

Thanks for your email. It was great to hear from you! **Let me tell you a bit about myself.** My name is Aziza and I'm 19. I'm from Tashkent, the capital of Uzbekistan. It's a big, multicultural city and people here speak Uzbek and Russian.

I live with my parents and my younger brother. I'm a student at university and I study economics. In my free time, I like reading and going for walks with my friends.

I'm learning English because I want to work abroad one day. **What about you?** Why are you learning Uzbek?

Write back soon!

Best wishes,

Aziza

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 1.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Starting and ending an informal email

Informal emails go to friends and people you know. Start with a friendly greeting, say why you are writing, and finish with a short ending before your name.

Start	Hi Emma, / Hello Tom, / Dear Anna,
First line	Thanks for your email. / It was great to hear from you.
Ask a question	What about you? / How are things with you?
Before the end	Write back soon! / I hope to hear from you soon.
End	Best wishes, / Take care, / Love, (for family and close friends)

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UNIT 1.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **introduce yourself** — o‘zingizni tanishtirmoq
- **multicultural** — ko‘p madaniyatli
- **be fluent in** — ...ni ravon bilmoq
- **get to know** — yaqindan tanishmoq
- **outgoing** — ochiqko‘ngil
- **be from** — ...dan bo‘lmoq
- **mother tongue** — ona tili
- **keep in touch** — aloqada bo‘lmoq
- **have a lot in common** — ko‘p umumiy jihatga ega bo‘lmoq
- **take after** — ...ga tortmoq

UNIT 1.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

get to know | in common | in touch | mother tongue | take after

1. I’m from Samarkand, but my _____ is Tajik.
2. My sister and I like the same music – we have a lot _____ .
3. I want to _____ my new classmates better.
4. Let’s keep _____ after the course finishes.
5. I _____ my father – we are both very calm.

UNIT 1.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Email to a new pen friend

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say where you are from and describe your city

PARAGRAPH 2
tell him or her about your family

PARAGRAPH 3
say what you do and what you like doing

PARAGRAPH 4
ask two questions about your pen friend

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UNIT 1.6 · WRITING TASK · INFORMAL EMAIL

Email to a new pen friend

You have a new pen friend from another country. Write an email to introduce yourself.

In your informal email:

- ✔ say where you are from and describe your city
- ✔ tell him or her about your family
- ✔ say what you do and what you like doing
- ✔ ask two questions about your pen friend

Write 80–100 words

REMEMBER: STARTING AND ENDING AN INFORMAL EMAIL

Start	Hi Emma, / Hello Tom, / Dear Anna,
First line	Thanks for your email. / It was great to hear from you.
Ask a question	What about you? / How are things with you?
Before the end	Write back soon! / I hope to hear from you soon.

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 80–100 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I started with a greeting and finished with “Best wishes,” and my name.
- ☐ I asked my pen friend two questions.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 1.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Is it important to learn a foreign language? Why or why not?"

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- more job opportunities in the future
- you can travel and talk to people from other countries
- you can watch films and read books in the original language
- it is hard and takes a lot of time

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

introduce yourself · be from · multicultural · mother tongue · be fluent in · keep in touch · get to know · have a lot in common

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UNIT 2

My Day

Text type: Blog post: a typical day · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 2.1 · MODEL TEXT · BLOG POST: A TYPICAL DAY

A day in my life

I'm a student, so my weekdays are quite busy. **As a rule,** I get up at half past six. **First,** I have a shower and get dressed. **Then** I have breakfast with my family – usually bread, eggs and green tea.

At about half past seven, I take the bus to university. My first class starts at eight. I **usually** have lunch with my friends in the canteen.

I get home at five. **After that,** I do my homework and help my mum with the housework. In the evening, I **hardly ever** watch TV – I prefer reading or chatting with friends online.

Finally, I go to bed at about eleven. I'm **definitely a morning person!**

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 2.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Time order words and how often

Use sequencing words to show the order of your day. Put frequency adverbs before the main verb, but after the verb "be".

Order	First, … Then … After that, … Finally, …
Time	at 7 o'clock · in the morning · on Saturdays · at the weekend
Frequency	always · usually · often · sometimes · hardly ever · never
Position	I usually get up at 7. / I am always tired on Mondays.
Longer	once a week · twice a day · every evening

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UNIT 2.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **daily routine**
  kundalik tartib
- **morning person**
  erta turishni yoqtiradigan odam
- **commute**
  qatnamoq
- **get enough sleep**
  yetarlicha uxlamoq
- **hang out with**
  ...bilan vaqt o'tkazmoq
- **as a rule**
  odatda
- **busy schedule**
  band jadval
- **stay up late**
  kech yotmoq
- **unwind**
  dam olib charchoqni chiqarmoq
- **do the housework**
  uy ishlarini qilmoq

UNIT 2.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

do the housework · get enough sleep · hang out with · stay up late · unwind

1. I never _____ on weekdays because I get up early.
2. After work, I like to _____ with a good book.
3. At the weekend I _____ my friends in the park.
4. My mum and I _____ together on Sundays.
5. Students need to _____ – at least eight hours.

UNIT 2.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Blog post: my weekend

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
what time you get up and what you do in the morning

PARAGRAPH 2
what you do in the afternoon and who with

PARAGRAPH 3
how you relax in the evening

PARAGRAPH 4
say why you like or don't like weekends

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UNIT 2.6 · WRITING TASK · BLOG POST: A TYPICAL DAY

Blog post: my weekend

Write a short blog post about your typical weekend.

In your blog post:

- ✔ what time you get up and what you do in the morning
- ✔ what you do in the afternoon and who with
- ✔ how you relax in the evening
- ✔ say why you like or don't like weekends

Write 80–100 words

REMEMBER: TIME ORDER WORDS AND HOW OFTEN

Order	First, … Then … After that, … Finally, …
Time	at 7 o'clock · in the morning · on Saturdays · at the weekend
Frequency	always · usually · often · sometimes · hardly ever · never
Position	I usually get up at 7. / I am always tired on Mondays.

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 80–100 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I used at least four time order words (first, then, after that, finally).
- ☐ I put always / usually / never in the right place.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 2.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Do people today have enough free time? Give reasons for your answer."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- people work and study long hours
- many people spend free time on their phones
- technology saves time (online shopping, delivery)
- people are stressed and tired

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

daily routine · as a rule · morning person · busy schedule · commute · stay up late · get enough sleep · unwind

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UNIT 3

Work

Text type: Formal email: job application · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 3.1 · MODEL TEXT · FORMAL EMAIL: JOB APPLICATION

Application for a part-time job

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to apply for the part-time job as a shop assistant which I saw on your website.

I am 20 years old and I am a student at Tashkent State University. I have some work experience: last summer I worked in a café, so I am used to talking to customers. I am friendly, reliable and good at teamwork.

I am free in the evenings and at weekends. I speak Uzbek, Russian and English.

I have attached my CV. **I look forward to hearing from you.**

Yours faithfully,

Dilshod Karimov

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 3.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Formal and informal language

In a formal email, write full forms (I am, not I'm), use polite phrases and don't use "Hi" or "Thanks!". Say why you are writing in the first line.

Start	Dear Sir or Madam, (name unknown) / Dear Mr Brown, (name known)
Reason	I am writing to apply for … / I am writing to ask about …
Informal → formal	I want → I would like · get → receive · ask → enquire
Before the end	I look forward to hearing from you.
End	Yours faithfully, (Sir or Madam) / Yours sincerely, (Mr Brown)

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UNIT 3.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **apply for a job** — ishga ariza bermoq
- **work experience** — ish tajribasi
- **be responsible for** — ...uchun mas'ul bo'lmoq
- **reliable** — ishonchli
- **employer** — ish beruvchi
- **part-time job** — yarim kunlik ish
- **qualifications** — malaka
- **be good at** — ...ni yaxshi bilmoq
- **teamwork** — jamoaviy ish
- **well-paid** — yaxshi maoshli

UNIT 3.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

apply for a job | Employers | part-time job | reliable | was responsible for

1. I would like to _____ as a receptionist.
2. Many students have a _____ in the evenings.
3. In my last job I _____ customer emails.
4. She is very _____ – she is never late.
5. _____ usually want young people with good communication skills.

UNIT 3.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Applying for a summer job

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say which job you are applying for and where you saw it

PARAGRAPH 2
give some information about yourself and your studies

PARAGRAPH 3
describe your skills and any work experience

PARAGRAPH 4
say when you are free to work

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UNIT 3.6 · WRITING TASK · FORMAL EMAIL: JOB APPLICATION

Applying for a summer job

You saw this advert: "Summer job at the City Sports Centre. We need friendly young people to help at reception. Evenings and weekends." Write an email to apply.

In your formal email:

- ✔ say which job you are applying for and where you saw it
- ✔ give some information about yourself and your studies
- ✔ describe your skills and any work experience
- ✔ say when you are free to work

Write 80–100 words

REMEMBER: FORMAL AND INFORMAL LANGUAGE

Start	Dear Sir or Madam, (name unknown) / Dear Mr Brown, (name known)
Reason	I am writing to apply for … / I am writing to ask about …
Informal → formal	I want → I would like · get → receive · ask → enquire
Before the end	I look forward to hearing from you.

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 80–100 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I used formal language (no contractions, no "Hi").
- ☐ I finished with "I look forward to hearing from you." and "Yours faithfully,".
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 3.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Is it better to have an interesting job or a well-paid job? Give your opinion."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- an interesting job makes you happy every day
- you need money for a family, a home and a car
- people with interesting jobs work harder
- a well-paid but boring job can make you stressed

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

apply for a job · part-time job · work experience · qualifications · be responsible for · be good at · reliable · teamwork

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UNIT 4

Places and Things

Text type: Description of a place · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 4.1 · MODEL TEXT · DESCRIPTION OF A PLACE

My neighbourhood

I live in a **quiet residential area** in the north of Tashkent. **There are** lots of tall apartment buildings and **there is** a big park **opposite** my flat.

The best thing about my neighbourhood is that everything is **within walking distance**. **Next to** my building there is a small supermarket, and there is a bakery **at the end of the street**. My school is only ten minutes away on foot.

In the evening, families walk in the park and children play football. The only problem is the traffic – the main road is very **crowded** in the morning.

All in all, it's a **safe and friendly** place to live.

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 4.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

There is / there are and describing a place

Use there is with one thing and there are with more than one. Use prepositions to say where things are, and adjectives to say what they are like.

- There is a park near my home. / There are two schools.
- There isn't a cinema. / There aren't any shops.
- **Place** — next to · opposite · behind · in front of · between · near
- **Adjectives** — quiet · noisy · crowded · modern · clean · safe · friendly
- **Finish** — All in all, … / Overall, it's a … place to live.

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UNIT 4.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **residential area** — turar-joy hududi
- **neighbourhood** — mahalla
- **within walking distance** — piyoda masofada
- **crowded** — gavjum
- **peaceful** — osuda
- **public transport** — jamoat transporti
- **city centre** — shahar markazi
- **cost of living** — yashash narxi
- **spacious** — keng
- **cosy** — shinam

UNIT 4.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

cost of living · cosy · crowded · residential area · within walking distance

1. The shops are _____ , so we don't need a car.
2. The metro is always _____ at 8 a.m.
3. Our flat is small but very _____ .
4. The _____ is high in big cities.
5. I live in a _____ , far from the factories.

UNIT 4.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Describing my home

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say where your home is and what type of home it is

PARAGRAPH 2
describe the rooms and your favourite room

PARAGRAPH 3
say what is near your home

PARAGRAPH 4
say what you like and don't like about it

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UNIT 4.6 · WRITING TASK · DESCRIPTION OF A PLACE

Describing my home

Your English teacher asked you to write a description of your home for the class magazine.

In your description of a place:

- ✔ say where your home is and what type of home it is
- ✔ describe the rooms and your favourite room
- ✔ say what is near your home
- ✔ say what you like and don't like about it

Write 90–110 words

REMEMBER: THERE IS / THERE ARE AND DESCRIBING A PLACE

There is a park near my home. / There are two schools.

There isn't a cinema. / There aren't any shops.

Place next to · opposite · behind · in front of · between · near

Adjectives quiet · noisy · crowded · modern · clean · safe · friendly

✓ SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 90–110 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I used there is / there are correctly.
- ☐ I used at least three prepositions of place and four adjectives.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 4.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Is it better to live in a city or in the countryside? Give reasons."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- more jobs, universities and shops in the city
- fresh air and peace in the countryside
- cities are noisy, crowded and expensive
- fewer services (hospitals, transport) in villages

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

residential area · neighbourhood · within walking distance · crowded · peaceful · public transport · city centre · cost of living

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UNIT 5

Clothes and Shopping

Text type: Email of complaint · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 5.1 · MODEL TEXT · EMAIL OF COMPLAINT
Problem with my order

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to complain about a jacket which I ordered from your website on 3 March. My order number is 45219.

When the parcel arrived, the jacket was the wrong size. I ordered a medium, but you sent me a large. **Also,** one of the buttons was broken.

I would like to exchange the jacket for a medium in the same colour. If this is not possible, **could you please** give me a full refund? I have kept the receipt.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,

Kamola Rahimova

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 5.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS
Polite requests and complaints

When you complain, explain the problem clearly and calmly, then say what you want the company to do. Polite requests sound better than orders.

Problem	I am writing to complain about … / Unfortunately, …
Details	I ordered … , but … / When it arrived, …
Request	I would like to … / Could you please … ?
Not	Give me my money back! → Could you please give me a refund?
End	I look forward to hearing from you.

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UNIT 5.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **online order** — onlayn buyurtma
- **the wrong size** — noto‘g‘ri o‘lcham
- **exchange** — almashtirmoq
- **make a complaint** — shikoyat qilmoq
- **value for money** — narxiga arziydigan
- **try on** — kiyib ko‘rmoq
- **get a refund** — pulni qaytarib olmoq
- **receipt** — chek
- **customer service** — mijozlarga xizmat
- **on sale** — chegirmada

UNIT 5.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

customer service | exchange | on sale | receipt | value for money

1. These shoes are great _____ – cheap but good quality.
2. The shirt didn’t fit, so I asked to _____ it for a smaller one.
3. You can’t get a refund without the _____ .
4. I bought this coat _____ – it was 50% cheaper.
5. The _____ in this shop is excellent; they always help you.

UNIT 5.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: My order was wrong

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say what you bought and when

PARAGRAPH 2
explain the problem (wrong colour, size or damage)

PARAGRAPH 3
say what you would like the shop to do

PARAGRAPH 4
say how they can contact you

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UNIT 5.6 · WRITING TASK · EMAIL OF COMPLAINT

My order was wrong

You bought a pair of trainers online, but there is a problem. Write an email to the shop.

In your email of complaint:

- ✔ say what you bought and when
- ✔ explain the problem (wrong colour, size or damage)
- ✔ say what you would like the shop to do
- ✔ say how they can contact you

Write 80–100 words

REMEMBER: POLITE REQUESTS AND COMPLAINTS

Problem	I am writing to complain about … / Unfortunately, …
Details	I ordered … , but … / When it arrived, …
Request	I would like to … / Could you please … ?
Not	Give me my money back! → Could you please give me a refund?

✓ SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 80–100 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I explained the problem clearly and politely.
- ☐ I used “I would like …” or “Could you please …?”.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 5.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Is shopping online better than shopping in shops? Give your opinion."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- online shopping is fast and you can do it at home
- there is more choice and prices are often lower
- in shops you can try clothes on
- online you sometimes get the wrong size or bad quality

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

online order · try on · the wrong size · get a refund · exchange · receipt · make a complaint · customer service

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UNIT 6

Past Times

Text type: Story: a memorable day · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 6.1 · MODEL TEXT · STORY: A MEMORABLE DAY

An unforgettable day

Last summer, my family and I went to Chimgan mountains for the day. We **left home early** in the morning because it was a long drive.

When we arrived, the weather was sunny and warm. **First,** we walked to a beautiful waterfall. **Then** we had a picnic next to the river. My mum made plov and it was delicious.

In the afternoon, my brother and I went on the cable car. **At first** I was scared, but the view from the top was amazing!

Suddenly, it started to rain, so we ran back to the car. We got very wet, but we laughed all the way home.

It was one of the best days of my life.

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 6.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Telling a story in the past

Use the past simple for the main events. Use time words to show the order, and add feelings to make your story interesting.

Regular	walk → walked · arrive → arrived · stop → stopped
Irregular	go → went · see → saw · make → made · eat → ate
Beginning	Last summer, … / One day, … / A few years ago, …
Middle	When we arrived, … · At first, … · Suddenly, …
Ending	In the end, … / It was one of the best days of my life.

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UNIT 6.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **memorable** — esda qolarli
- **unforgettable** — unutilmas
- **at first** — avvaliga
- **suddenly** — to‘satdan
- **in the end** — oxir-oqibat
- **be scared** — qo‘rqmoq
- **go wrong** — noto‘g‘ri ketmoq
- **day trip** — bir kunlik sayohat
- **give up** — taslim bo‘lmoq
- **be proud of** — ...dan faxrlanmoq

UNIT 6.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

At first | give up | proud of | suddenly | went wrong

1. _____ the test was difficult, but then it got easier.
2. We were walking home when _____ it started to snow.
3. Everything _____ – we missed the bus and lost our tickets.
4. I was tired, but I didn’t _____ and finished the race.
5. My parents were very _____ me when I passed the exam.

UNIT 6.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: A day I will never forget

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say when it was and who you were with

PARAGRAPH 2
describe what happened, in order

PARAGRAPH 3
say how you felt

PARAGRAPH 4
say why this day was special

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UNIT 6.6 · WRITING TASK · STORY: A MEMORABLE DAY

A day I will never forget

Write a story for a school competition with the title "A day I will never forget".

In your story:

- ✔ say when it was and who you were with
- ✔ describe what happened, in order
- ✔ say how you felt
- ✔ say why this day was special

Write 100–120 words

REMEMBER: TELLING A STORY IN THE PAST

Regular	walk → walked · arrive → arrived · stop → stopped
Irregular	go → went · see → saw · make → made · eat → ate
Beginning	Last summer, … / One day, … / A few years ago, …
Middle	When we arrived, … · At first, … · Suddenly, …

✓ SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 100–120 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I used the past simple correctly (check irregular verbs!).
- ☐ I used at least four time words (first, then, suddenly, in the end).
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 6.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Was life better in the past than it is today? Give reasons for your answer."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- today we have better medicine and technology
- in the past people spent more time with family
- life was quieter and less stressful
- today it is easier to travel and study

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

memorable · unforgettable · at first · suddenly · in the end · be scared · go wrong · day trip

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UNIT 7

Health and Sport

Text type: Message giving advice · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 7.1 · MODEL TEXT · MESSAGE GIVING ADVICE

Re: I can't sleep!

Hi Laylo,

I'm sorry to hear that you can't sleep. Exams are stressful, but don't worry – **here are some ideas.**

First of all, you **shouldn't** drink coffee or tea in the evening. Have warm milk instead.

I think you should stop using your phone an hour before bed. The light from the screen keeps you awake.

Why don't you go for a walk or do some exercise in the afternoon? It really helps you relax.

If I were you, I'd also take short breaks when you study.

I hope you feel better soon!

Love,

Nodira

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 7.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Giving advice

Use should / shouldn't + verb to give advice. Use different phrases to make your message friendly and not repetitive.

- **You should + verb** — You should get more sleep.
- **You shouldn't + verb** — You shouldn't eat junk food.
- Why don't you + verb? Why don't you join a gym?
- **If I were you, I'd + verb** — If I were you, I'd see a doctor.
- **Feelings** — I'm sorry to hear that ... / I hope you feel better soon!

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UNIT 7.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **stay healthy** — sog‘lom bo‘lib qolmoq
- **junk food** — zararli ovqat
- **reduce stress** — stressni kamaytirmoq
- **get in shape** — qaddi-qomatni tiklamoq
- **catch a cold** — shamollamoq
- **balanced diet** — muvozanatli ovqatlanish
- **keep fit** — jismonan chiniqqan bo‘lmoq
- **take a break** — tanaffus qilmoq
- **healthy lifestyle** — sog‘lom turmush tarzi
- **recover** — tuzalmoq

UNIT 7.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

balanced diet | catch a cold | junk food | keep fit | take a break

1. You should eat less _____ like burgers and chips.
2. I go swimming twice a week to _____ .
3. When you study for a long time, _____ every hour.
4. Wear a warm coat or you’ll _____ .
5. A _____ includes fruit, vegetables and protein.

UNIT 7.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Advice for a friend

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say you are sorry to hear about the problem

PARAGRAPH 2
give advice about food

PARAGRAPH 3
give advice about exercise and sleep

PARAGRAPH 4
say something kind at the end

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UNIT 7.6 · WRITING TASK · MESSAGE GIVING ADVICE

Advice for a friend

Your friend wrote: "I feel tired all the time and I want to be healthier. What should I do?" Write a reply.

In your message giving advice:

- ✔ say you are sorry to hear about the problem
- ✔ give advice about food
- ✔ give advice about exercise and sleep
- ✔ say something kind at the end

Write 80–100 words

REMEMBER: GIVING ADVICE

You should + verb	You should get more sleep.
You shouldn't + verb	You shouldn't eat junk food.
Why don't you + verb? Why don't you join a gym?	
If I were you, I'd + verb	If I were you, I'd see a doctor.

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 80–100 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I used at least four different advice phrases.
- ☐ I started and finished in a friendly way.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 7.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Should schools give students more time for sport? Why or why not?"

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- sport keeps children healthy and fit
- students learn teamwork and discipline
- students need time for important subjects like maths
- sport reduces stress before exams

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

stay healthy · balanced diet · junk food · keep fit · reduce stress · take a break · get in shape · healthy lifestyle

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UNIT 8

Travel and Adventure

Text type: Travel blog: recommending a place · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 8.1 · MODEL TEXT · TRAVEL BLOG: RECOMMENDING A PLACE

Why you must visit Khiva

If you visit Uzbekistan, **you must see** Khiva. It's a small city in the west of the country and **it's definitely worth visiting.**

The old town, Itchan Kala, is like an open-air museum. There are ancient mosques, palaces and towers. **The best way to** see it is on foot, because everything is within walking distance.

The best time to visit is in spring or autumn, **because** summer is boiling hot. You **should** stay in a small family hotel – they are cheap and the locals are very friendly.

Don't forget to try shivit oshi, a green noodle dish. **I highly recommend** it!

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 8.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Giving reasons and recommending

When you recommend something, give clear reasons. Use because to give a reason and so to give a result.

Reason	The best time to visit is spring because it isn't too hot.
Result	It's a small city, so you can walk everywhere.
Recommend	You must see … / It's definitely worth visiting.
Advice	You should … / Don't forget to …
Strong ending	I highly recommend it! / You won't regret it!

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UNIT 8.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **be worth visiting**
  borishga arziydi
- **the best time to visit**
  borish uchun eng yaxshi vaqt
- **go sightseeing**
  diqqatga sazovor joylarni ko‘rmoq
- **accommodation**
  turar joy
- **off the beaten track**
  sayyohlar kam boradigan joyda
- **must-see**
  albatta ko‘rish kerak bo‘lgan
- **book in advance**
  oldindan band qilmoq
- **friendly locals**
  samimiy mahalliy aholi
- **affordable**
  hamyonbop
- **highly recommend**
  qat’iy tavsiya qilmoq

UNIT 8.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

affordable | book in advance | must-see | off the beaten track | sightseeing

1. Hotels are busy in summer, so _____ .
2. The old market is a _____ for every tourist.
3. The hostel is clean and _____ – only $10 a night.
4. We spent the day _____ in the old town.
5. This village is _____ – there are almost no tourists.

UNIT 8.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Recommend a place

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say which place it is and where it is

PARAGRAPH 2
describe what visitors can see and do there

PARAGRAPH 3
say when to go and where to stay

PARAGRAPH 4
give a reason why it is special

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UNIT 8.6 · WRITING TASK · TRAVEL BLOG: RECOMMENDING A PLACE

Recommend a place

A travel website asks: "Which place in your country should every visitor see?" Write a short blog post.

In your travel blog:

- ✔ say which place it is and where it is
- ✔ describe what visitors can see and do there
- ✔ say when to go and where to stay
- ✔ give a reason why it is special

Write 100–120 words

REMEMBER: GIVING REASONS AND RECOMMENDING

Reason	The best time to visit is spring because it isn't too hot.
Result	It's a small city, so you can walk everywhere.
Recommend	You must see … / It's definitely worth visiting.
Advice	You should … / Don't forget to …

✓ SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 100–120 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I gave at least three reasons with because or so.
- ☐ I used two recommending phrases (you must see, worth visiting).
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 8.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Is it better to travel alone or with friends? Give your opinion."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- friends make the trip more fun and you can share costs
- travelling alone is more flexible
- alone you meet more new people
- travelling with others is safer

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

be worth visiting · must-see · the best time to visit · book in advance · go sightseeing · friendly locals · accommodation · affordable

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UNIT 9

Food and Drink

Text type: Restaurant review · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 9.1 · MODEL TEXT · RESTAURANT REVIEW

Review: Silk Road Café ★★★★☆

Last Friday I went to Silk Road Café with two friends. It's a small restaurant in the city centre, **within walking distance of** the metro.

The atmosphere was cosy and the waiters were very friendly. We **ordered** lagman, a fresh salad and some green tea. The lagman was **absolutely delicious** and the portions were big.

However, we waited 40 minutes for our food, **which was** too long. The dessert was also a bit too sweet for me.

Overall, it's a great place for lunch with friends and the prices are **reasonable**. **I'd recommend it,** but don't go if you are in a hurry!

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 9.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Writing a review

A good review has four parts: where and when, what was good, what was not so good, and your final opinion. Use however to show the other side.

1 Introduction	Last Friday I went to … It's a … in …
2 Good points	The food was delicious. The staff were friendly.
3 Bad points	However, … / The only problem was …
4 Opinion	Overall, … / I'd recommend it to …
Strong adjectives	delicious · tasty · fresh · spicy · cosy · overpriced

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UNIT 9.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **eat out** — tashqarida ovqatlanmoq
- **book a table** — stol band qilmoq
- **order** — buyurtma bermoq
- **tasty** — mazali
- **spicy** — achchiq
- **portion** — porsiya
- **reasonable prices** — maqbul narxlar
- **overpriced** — haddan tashqari qimmat
- **friendly service** — samimiy xizmat
- **home-cooked meal** — uyda tayyorlangan ovqat

UNIT 9.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

book a table | home-cooked meal | overpriced | portions | spicy

1. It's a popular place, so you should _____ .
2. The coffee was nice but _____ – $8 a cup!
3. The _____ were huge – I couldn't finish my plate.
4. I can't eat _____ food – it hurts my stomach.
5. Nothing is better than a _____ from my grandmother.

UNIT 9.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Review a place to eat

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say where it is and when you went

PARAGRAPH 2
describe the food and drinks you had

PARAGRAPH 3
describe the atmosphere, service and prices

PARAGRAPH 4
say who you would recommend it to

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UNIT 9.6 · WRITING TASK · RESTAURANT REVIEW

Review a place to eat

Write a review of a café or restaurant you know for a food website.

In your restaurant review:

- ✔ say where it is and when you went
- ✔ describe the food and drinks you had
- ✔ describe the atmosphere, service and prices
- ✔ say who you would recommend it to

Write 100–120 words

REMEMBER: WRITING A REVIEW

1 Introduction	Last Friday I went to … It's a … in …
2 Good points	The food was delicious. The staff were friendly.
3 Bad points	However, … / The only problem was …
4 Opinion	Overall, … / I'd recommend it to …

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 100–120 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ My review has four parts: introduction, good points, bad points, opinion.
- ☐ I used however and at least four food adjectives.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 9.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

> *"Should children learn to cook at school? Give your opinion."*

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- cooking is an important life skill
- children learn about healthy food
- parents can teach cooking at home
- schools need time for academic subjects

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

eat out · book a table · order · tasty · spicy · portion · reasonable prices · overpriced

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UNIT 10

The Natural World

Text type: Description of a natural place · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 10.1 · MODEL TEXT · DESCRIPTION OF A NATURAL PLACE

My favourite place in nature

My favourite place in nature is Charvak Lake, about 80 km from Tashkent. It's **surrounded by** high mountains and the water is **bright blue**.

In summer, it's **much cooler than** the city, so many families go there at the weekend. You can swim, go boating or just sit by the water and **enjoy the view**.

The most beautiful time is early in the morning. It's **peaceful** and you can only hear the birds. The air is fresh and clean.

When I'm there, I feel **calm and happy.** I think it's **one of the most beautiful** places in Uzbekistan.

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 10.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Comparing and describing

Use comparatives to compare two things and superlatives to say something is number one. Use the five senses to make your description come alive.

Short adjectives	cool → cooler than → the coolest
Long adjectives	beautiful → more beautiful than → the most beautiful
Irregular	good → better → the best · bad → worse → the worst
Senses	You can see … / hear … / smell … / feel …
One of the + superlative + plural noun	one of the most beautiful places

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UNIT 10.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **scenery** — manzara
- **surrounded by** — ...bilan o‘ralgan
- **fresh air** — toza havo
- **national park** — milliy bog‘
- **pollution** — ifloslanish
- **breathtaking** — hayratlanarli
- **peaceful** — osuda
- **wildlife** — yovvoyi tabiat
- **protect the environment** — atrof-muhitni himoya qilmoq
- **climate change** — iqlim o‘zgarishi

UNIT 10.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

breathtaking | national park | pollution | protect the environment | surrounded by

1. The village is _____ fields and orchards.
2. The view from the top was _____ – I took 100 photos!
3. Cars and factories cause air _____ .
4. We should all _____ – for example, by recycling.
5. Many animals live in the _____ , and hunting is not allowed there.

UNIT 10.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: A beautiful place in my country

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say where it is and how to get there

PARAGRAPH 2
describe what you can see, hear and do there

PARAGRAPH 3
compare it with another place (e.g. the city)

PARAGRAPH 4
say how you feel there and why people should visit

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UNIT 10.6 · WRITING TASK · DESCRIPTION OF A NATURAL PLACE

A beautiful place in my country

An international student magazine wants articles about beautiful natural places. Write a description of a place in your country.

In your description of a natural place:

- ✔ say where it is and how to get there
- ✔ describe what you can see, hear and do there
- ✔ compare it with another place (e.g. the city)
- ✔ say how you feel there and why people should visit

Write 100–120 words

REMEMBER: COMPARING AND DESCRIBING

Short adjectives	cool → cooler than → the coolest
Long adjectives	beautiful → more beautiful than → the most beautiful
Irregular	good → better → the best · bad → worse → the worst
Senses	You can see … / hear … / smell … / feel …

✓ SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 100–120 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I used at least two comparatives and one superlative.
- ☐ I described the place with my senses (see, hear, feel).
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 10.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"What can people do to protect the environment? Give your ideas."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- use public transport, walk or cycle
- recycle and use less plastic
- save water and electricity at home
- governments should plant more trees and stop pollution

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

scenery · breathtaking · surrounded by · peaceful · fresh air · wildlife · national park · protect the environment

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UNIT 11

Communities

Text type: Formal letter: making a suggestion · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 11.1 · MODEL TEXT · FORMAL LETTER: MAKING A SUGGESTION

A suggestion for our neighbourhood

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to suggest an improvement for our neighbourhood, Yunusabad 5.

At the moment, there is nowhere for children to play. They play football in the car park, which is **dangerous**. **In addition,** there is no place for older people to sit outside.

I would like to suggest building a small playground and a garden with benches on the empty land next to School No. 112. Local residents **would be happy to** help to plant trees and keep the area clean.

I believe this would bring the community together.

Thank you for your time. **I look forward to hearing from you.**

Yours faithfully,

Shahlo Nazarova

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 11.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Paragraphs in a formal letter

Plan your letter in paragraphs. Each paragraph has one main idea. Use formal linking words to add ideas and to suggest solutions.

- **Paragraph 1** — why you are writing — I am writing to suggest / complain about ...
- **Paragraph 2** — the situation now — At the moment, ... / In addition, ...
- **Paragraph 3** — your suggestion — I would like to suggest + -ing / I believe this would ...
- **Paragraph 4** — polite ending — Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.
- **Formal linkers** — In addition · However · Therefore · As a result

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UNIT 11.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **community spirit** — jamoaviylik ruhi
- **volunteer** — ko‘ngilli
- **improve** — yaxshilamoq
- **facilities** — qulayliklar
- **support** — qo‘llab-quvvatlamoq
- **local residents** — mahalliy aholi
- **local council** — mahalliy hokimiyat
- **bring people together** — odamlarni birlashtirmoq
- **deal with a problem** — muammoni hal qilmoq
- **make a suggestion** — taklif kiritmoq

UNIT 11.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

bring people together | facilities | local residents | make a suggestion | volunteer

1. I would like to _____ to improve our park.
2. Many _____ are unhappy about the noise from the new road.
3. Festivals _____ and help neighbours meet.
4. Our town needs better sports _____ , like a swimming pool.
5. I work as a _____ at the animal shelter every Saturday.

UNIT 11.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Write to your local council

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
say why you are writing

PARAGRAPH 2
describe the problem and who it affects

PARAGRAPH 3
suggest a solution

PARAGRAPH 4
say how the solution will help the community

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UNIT 11.6 · WRITING TASK · FORMAL LETTER: MAKING A SUGGESTION

Write to your local council

There is a problem in your area (for example: no bus stop, dirty streets, nothing for teenagers to do). Write a letter to the local council.

In your formal letter:

- ✔ say why you are writing
- ✔ describe the problem and who it affects
- ✔ suggest a solution
- ✔ say how the solution will help the community

Write 100–120 words

REMEMBER: PARAGRAPHS IN A FORMAL LETTER

Paragraph 1	why you are writing — I am writing to suggest / complain about …
Paragraph 2	the situation now — At the moment, … / In addition, …
Paragraph 3	your suggestion — I would like to suggest + -ing / I believe this would …
Paragraph 4	polite ending — Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 100–120 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ My letter has four paragraphs with one idea each.
- ☐ I used formal language and at least two formal linkers.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 11.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Should young people do volunteer work? Give reasons for your opinion."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- young people gain experience for their CV
- they help people in need and feel useful
- they learn teamwork and responsibility
- students are busy with studies and exams

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

community spirit · local residents · volunteer · local council · improve · bring people together · facilities · deal with a problem

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UNIT 12

Arts and Entertainment

Text type: Film review and opinion · Opinion paragraph

4 PAGES

UNIT 12.1 · MODEL TEXT · FILM REVIEW AND OPINION

Film review: The Lion King

I recently watched The Lion King at the cinema with my younger sister. **It's an animated film** about a young lion, Simba, who must become king after his father dies.

What I liked most was the music – the songs are fantastic and I still sing them! The animation is beautiful too, and some scenes made me cry.

On the other hand, some parts were a bit scary for small children, and the film is quite long.

In my opinion, it's a wonderful family film with an important message about responsibility. **I'd give it** four stars out of five, and **I highly recommend it.**

Find the highlighted phrases. Which ones can you use in your own writing?

UNIT 12.2 · LANGUAGE FOCUS

Giving your opinion

Show your opinion clearly, give reasons, and show the other side. Don't tell the ending (no spoilers!).

Opinion	In my opinion, ... / I think ... / For me, ...
What was good	What I liked most was ... / The best thing about it is ...
Other side	On the other hand, ... / However, ...
Rating	I'd give it ... stars out of five.
Adjectives	exciting · moving · funny · boring · scary · overrated

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UNIT 12.3 · USEFUL VOCABULARY

Words & phrases

- **be based on**
  ...ga asoslangan
- **the main character**
  bosh qahramon
- **performance**
  ijro
- **overrated**
  ortiqcha maqtalgan
- **spoiler**
  syujetni oldindan aytish
- **plot**
  syujet
- **special effects**
  maxsus effektlar
- **moving**
  ta'sirli
- **well worth watching**
  ko'rishga arziydi
- **live music**
  jonli musiqa

UNIT 12.4 · PRACTICE

Complete the sentences

based on | moving | overrated | performance | spoilers

1. The film is _____ a true story.
2. Everyone loves this series, but I think it's _____ .
3. The ending was so _____ that the audience cried.
4. Don't tell me the ending – no _____ , please!
5. The _____ was excellent – the actor really became the character.

UNIT 12.5 · PLAN YOUR WRITING

Plan: Review a film or series

Make notes for each paragraph before you write on the next page.

PARAGRAPH 1
give the name and type of film or series

PARAGRAPH 2
say briefly what it is about (no spoilers!)

PARAGRAPH 3
say what you liked and didn't like

PARAGRAPH 4
give it a rating and say who should watch it

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UNIT 12.6 · WRITING TASK · FILM REVIEW AND OPINION

Review a film or series

Write a review of a film or TV series you watched recently for an English-language website.

In your film review and opinion:

- ✔ give the name and type of film or series
- ✔ say briefly what it is about (no spoilers!)
- ✔ say what you liked and didn't like
- ✔ give it a rating and say who should watch it

Write 100–120 words

REMEMBER: GIVING YOUR OPINION

Opinion	In my opinion, … / I think … / For me, …
What was good	What I liked most was … / The best thing about it is …
Other side	On the other hand, … / However, …
Rating	I'd give it … stars out of five.

SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I wrote 100–120 words.
- ☐ I answered every point in the task.
- ☐ I used at least three phrases from the Vocabulary box.
- ☐ I didn't tell the ending.
- ☐ I gave my opinion with reasons and showed the other side.
- ☐ I checked spelling, capital letters and full stops.

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UNIT 12.7 · IELTS-STYLE TASK · OPINION

Give your opinion

"Is it better to watch films at home or at the cinema? Give your opinion."

Write an opinion paragraph of 80–120 words. Give reasons and examples.

IDEAS TO HELP YOU

- at the cinema the screen and sound are much better
- watching at home is cheaper and more comfortable
- you can pause the film at home
- going to the cinema is a social activity

PARAGRAPH PLAN

1. **Your opinion**
   In my opinion, ... / I think ...
2. **Reason 1 + example**
   Firstly, ... For example, ...
3. **Reason 2 or the other side**
   Secondly, ... / On the other hand, ... However, ...
4. **Conclusion**
   To sum up, ... / Overall, I believe ...

TRY TO USE

be based on · plot · the main character · special effects · performance · moving · overrated · well worth watching

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Writing bank

WRITING BANK
Informal emails

- Hi ... , / Dear ... ,
- Thanks for your email.
- It was great to hear from you.
- Let me tell you about ...
- What about you?
- Write back soon!
- Best wishes, / Take care,

WRITING BANK
Formal emails & letters

- Dear Sir or Madam, / Dear Mr ... ,
- I am writing to apply for / complain about / suggest ...
- I would like to ...
- Could you please ... ?
- In addition, ... / As a result, ...
- I look forward to hearing from you.
- Yours faithfully, / Yours sincerely,

WRITING BANK
Stories

- Last summer, ... / A few years ago, ...
- When we arrived, ...
- At first, ...
- Then ... / After that, ...
- Suddenly, ...
- In the end, ...
- It was one of the best days of my life.

WRITING BANK
Descriptions

- It's in ... / It's about ... km from ...
- It's surrounded by ...
- There is ... / There are ...
- You can see / hear / smell ...
- It's much ... than ...
- The best thing about it is ...
- All in all, it's a ... place.

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Writing bank

WRITING BANK Reviews

- Last … I went to / watched …
- It's a … (type) about …
- What I liked most was …
- The … was absolutely delicious / amazing.
- However, … / The only problem was …
- Overall, … / I'd give it … stars.
- I'd recommend it to …

WRITING BANK Opinion paragraphs

- In my opinion, … / I think …
- Firstly, … / Secondly, …
- For example, … / such as …
- This is because …
- On the other hand, … / However, …
- Some people say … , but …
- To sum up, … / Overall, I believe …

WRITING BANK Advice

- I'm sorry to hear that …
- You should / shouldn't …
- Why don't you … ?
- If I were you, I'd …
- It's a good idea to …
- Try to …
- I hope you feel better soon!

WRITING BANK Recommending

- You must see / try …
- It's definitely worth visiting.
- The best time to visit is …
- The best way to … is …
- Don't forget to …
- I highly recommend it!
- You won't regret it!

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COMMON MISTAKES

Ten-second checks before you finish

DON'T WRITE	WRITE	WHY?
~~× I am agree with you.~~	✓ I agree with you.	agree is a verb — no am
~~× He go to work every day.~~	✓ He goes to work every day.	he / she / it + -s
~~× I have 20 years.~~	✓ I am 20 (years old).	use be for age
~~× She is teacher.~~	✓ She is a teacher.	a / an before jobs
~~× People is very friendly.~~	✓ People are very friendly.	people is plural
~~× Yesterday I go to the cinema.~~	✓ Yesterday I went to the cinema.	past simple for finished time
~~× I went to home.~~	✓ I went home.	no to before home
~~× I can to swim.~~	✓ I can swim.	can + verb (no to)
~~× I very like football.~~	✓ I really like football.	very doesn't go before verbs
~~× It was very interesting film.~~	✓ It was a very interesting film.	a / an before singular nouns
~~× He explained me the rule.~~	✓ He explained the rule to me.	explain something to someone
~~× I need some informations / advices.~~	✓ I need some information / advice.	uncountable: no -s
~~× I am living in Tashkent since 2015.~~	✓ I have lived in Tashkent since 2015.	present perfect with since / for
~~× I married with Aziz.~~	✓ I am married to Aziz.	married to
~~× I listen music every day.~~	✓ I listen to music every day.	listen to
~~× dear sir or madam, i am writing ...~~	✓ Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing ...	capital letters: names, I, start of sentences

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ANSWER KEY

Practice: complete the sentences

Unit 1

1. mother tongue
2. in common
3. get to know
4. in touch
5. take after

Unit 2

1. stay up late
2. unwind
3. hang out with
4. do the housework
5. get enough sleep

Unit 3

1. apply for a job
2. part-time job
3. was responsible for
4. reliable
5. Employers

Unit 4

1. within walking distance
2. crowded
3. cosy
4. cost of living
5. residential area

Unit 5

1. value for money
2. exchange
3. receipt
4. on sale
5. customer service

Unit 6

1. At first
2. suddenly
3. went wrong
4. give up
5. proud of

Unit 7

1. junk food
2. keep fit
3. take a break
4. catch a cold
5. balanced diet

Unit 8

1. book in advance
2. must-see
3. affordable
4. sightseeing
5. off the beaten track

Unit 9

1. book a table
2. overpriced
3. portions
4. spicy
5. home-cooked meal

Unit 10

1. surrounded by
2. breathtaking
3. pollution
4. protect the environment
5. national park

Unit 11

1. make a suggestion
2. local residents
3. bring people together
4. facilities
5. volunteer

Unit 12

1. based on
2. overrated
3. moving
4. spoilers
5. performance

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Model answers · Units 1–2

UNIT 1 · WRITING TASK

Email to a new pen friend

Hi Lucas,

Thanks for your email! Let me tell you about myself. My name is Jasur and I'm from Bukhara. It's an old city with beautiful mosques and markets.

There are five people in my family: my parents, my two sisters and me. I take after my father – we are both quiet and hard-working.

I'm a student at college and I study IT. In my free time, I play football and watch films.

What about you? What is your city like, and what do you do at weekends?

Write back soon!

Best wishes,

Jasur

UNIT 1 · OPINION

Is it important to learn a foreign language? Why or why not?

In my opinion, it is very important to learn a foreign language.

Firstly, a foreign language gives you more job opportunities. For example, many companies in my country want workers who speak English.

Secondly, you can travel more easily and talk to people from other countries. You can also watch films and read books in the original language.

Of course, learning a language is not easy and it takes a lot of time. However, I think it is worth it.

To sum up, I believe everyone should learn at least one foreign language.

UNIT 2 · WRITING TASK

Blog post: my weekend

My weekend

I love weekends because I can relax! On Saturdays I usually get up at about nine. First, I have a big breakfast with my family. Then I go to the market with my mum.

In the afternoon, I often hang out with my friends. We sometimes play football in the park or go to a café.

In the evening, I unwind at home. I usually watch a film or read a book. On Sundays I visit my grandparents.

Weekends are the best part of the week – I can finally get enough sleep!

UNIT 2 · OPINION

Do people today have enough free time? Give reasons for your answer.

I don't think people today have enough free time.

Firstly, many people work or study very long hours. For example, my father often works until eight o'clock in the evening.

Secondly, when people have some free time, they often spend it on their phones, so they don't really relax.

On the other hand, technology helps us save time. We can shop and pay bills online.

To sum up, I believe most people today are too busy and need more real free time.

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Model answers · Units 3–4

UNIT 3 · WRITING TASK

Applying for a summer job

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to apply for the summer job at reception which I saw in the City Sports Centre advert.

I am 18 years old and I am in my last year at school. I am friendly and I am good at communicating with people. Last year I helped at a children's football club, so I have some work experience.

I am free every evening after five o'clock and at weekends.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,

Malika Saidova

UNIT 3 · OPINION

Is it better to have an interesting job or a well-paid job? Give your opinion.

In my opinion, it is better to have an interesting job than a well-paid job.

Firstly, we spend most of our day at work. If the job is interesting, we feel happy and we want to work hard.

Secondly, a boring job can make people stressed and tired, even if the salary is good. For example, my uncle left a well-paid job in a bank because he was unhappy.

However, money is also important, especially for people with families.

To sum up, I think the best job is an interesting one with a fair salary.

UNIT 4 · WRITING TASK

Describing my home

My home

I live in a flat on the fifth floor of a modern building near the city centre. There are three bedrooms, a living room, a kitchen and a bathroom.

My favourite room is my bedroom because it is spacious and light. There is a big desk next to the window, so I can see the park when I study.

Near my home there is a metro station and there are some nice cafés.

I like my home because it's cosy and everything is within walking distance. The only problem is that it's quite noisy at night.

UNIT 4 · OPINION

Is it better to live in a city or in the countryside? Give reasons.

I think it is better to live in a city, especially for young people.

Firstly, there are more jobs, universities and shops in the city. For example, most good universities in my country are in the capital.

Secondly, it is easier to get around because there is good public transport.

On the other hand, cities are noisy and crowded, and the cost of living is high. The countryside is peaceful and has fresh air.

To sum up, the city is better for studying and working, but the countryside is better for relaxing.

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Model answers · Units 5–6

UNIT 5 · WRITING TASK

My order was wrong

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to complain about a pair of trainers which I ordered from your website last week.

When the parcel arrived, the trainers were black, but I ordered white ones. Also, the box was damaged.

I would like to exchange them for the white trainers in size 40. If this is not possible, could you please give me a refund?

You can contact me by email or phone me on 90 123 45 67.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,

Bekzod Aliyev

UNIT 5 · OPINION

Is shopping online better than shopping in shops? Give your opinion.

In my opinion, online shopping is better for most things, but not for clothes.

Firstly, shopping online is fast and convenient. You can buy things at home, at any time of the day.

Secondly, there is more choice and the prices are often lower. For example, books and electronics are cheaper online.

However, in a shop you can try clothes on and check the quality. When I buy clothes online, they are sometimes the wrong size.

To sum up, I prefer shopping online, but I still buy clothes in shops.

UNIT 6 · WRITING TASK

A day I will never forget

A day I will never forget

Two years ago, I took part in a big chess competition in Samarkand. My father came with me.

At first, I was very nervous because the other players were older than me. I lost my first game and I wanted to give up. My father said, “Don’t give up – try again!”

Then I won three games in a row! In the end, I came second.

I was so proud of myself, and my father was proud of me too. It was an unforgettable day because I learned that hard work is more important than luck.

UNIT 6 · OPINION

Was life better in the past than it is today? Give reasons for your answer.

I think life today is better than in the past, but we lost some good things.

Firstly, we have much better medicine and technology. For example, people live longer and can talk to their families on video calls.

Secondly, it is easier to travel and study. Many young people study abroad today.

On the other hand, in the past people spent more time with their families and life was less stressful.

To sum up, I believe life is better today, but we should spend more time with the people we love.

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Model answers · Units 7–8

UNIT 7 · WRITING TASK

Advice for a friend

Hi Timur,

I'm sorry to hear that you feel tired all the time. Here is some advice.

First of all, you should have a balanced diet. You shouldn't eat so much junk food – try to eat more fruit and vegetables.

Why don't you join a gym or go running in the park? Exercise gives you more energy.

If I were you, I'd also go to bed earlier and stop using my phone at night.

I hope you feel better soon!

Take care,

Sardor

UNIT 7 · OPINION

Should schools give students more time for sport? Why or why not?

In my opinion, schools should give students more time for sport.

Firstly, sport keeps children healthy and fit. Nowadays many young people sit for long hours at computers.

Secondly, team sports teach important skills like teamwork and discipline. For example, football players must work together to win.

Some people think students need this time for important subjects like maths. However, exercise also helps students to reduce stress and study better.

To sum up, I believe more sport at school is good for both the body and the mind.

UNIT 8 · WRITING TASK

Recommend a place

You must visit Samarkand

If you come to Uzbekistan, you must visit Samarkand. It's in the centre of the country and it's easy to get there by fast train from Tashkent.

Samarkand is famous for the Registan, three beautiful old buildings with blue tiles. It's a must-see, especially at night when the lights are on.

The best time to visit is in April or October because the weather is warm but not too hot. You should stay in a guest house in the old town – it's affordable and the owners are friendly.

I highly recommend it – you won't regret it!

UNIT 8 · OPINION

Is it better to travel alone or with friends? Give your opinion.

In my opinion, it is better to travel with friends.

Firstly, a trip with friends is more fun. You can share good moments and talk about them later.

Secondly, it is cheaper because you can share the cost of hotels and taxis. It is also safer, especially in a new country.

On the other hand, when you travel alone, you are more flexible and you can meet new people more easily.

To sum up, travelling alone can be exciting, but I prefer to travel with my friends.

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Model answers · Units 9–10

UNIT 9 · WRITING TASK

Review a place to eat

Review: Bahor Restaurant

Last month I went to Bahor Restaurant for my mother's birthday. It's in Chilanzar, near the big park.

We ordered plov, shashlik and salads. The plov was absolutely delicious and the meat was tender. The atmosphere was cosy and there was live music. For dessert, we had fresh fruit and green tea, which was a perfect end to the meal.

However, the service was quite slow because the restaurant was very busy. It was also a bit overpriced.

Overall, it's a great place for family celebrations, but you should book a table in advance. I'd recommend it to anyone who loves traditional Uzbek food.

UNIT 9 · OPINION

Should children learn to cook at school? Give your opinion.

In my opinion, children should learn to cook at school.

Firstly, cooking is an important life skill. When young people go to university or start work, they need to make their own meals.

Secondly, cooking lessons teach children about healthy food. This is important because many children eat too much junk food.

Some people say parents can teach cooking at home. However, many parents are too busy.

To sum up, I believe cooking lessons would help children to live healthier lives.

UNIT 10 · WRITING TASK

A beautiful place in my country

The Zaamin Mountains

One of the most beautiful places in my country is Zaamin National Park. It's in the Jizzakh region, about four hours by car from Tashkent.

The park is surrounded by high mountains and old juniper trees. You can hear rivers and birds, and the air is much fresher than in the city. People go hiking, camping and horse riding there.

In summer it's cooler than Tashkent, so it's the best place to escape the heat. At night, the sky is clearer than anywhere else and you can see thousands of stars.

When I'm there, I feel peaceful and free. Everyone should visit Zaamin at least once!

UNIT 10 · OPINION

What can people do to protect the environment? Give your ideas.

There are many things that people can do to protect the environment.

Firstly, we can use public transport or walk and cycle instead of driving. This reduces air pollution in big cities.

Secondly, we should recycle and use less plastic. For example, we can take our own bags to the supermarket.

Thirdly, we can save water and electricity at home. Governments should also plant more trees and control factories.

To sum up, if everyone makes small changes, we can protect nature for future generations.

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Model answers · Units 11–12

UNIT 11 · WRITING TASK

Write to your local council

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to tell you about a problem in our area, Sergeli 7.

At the moment, there is nothing for teenagers to do in the evenings. As a result, many young people spend hours on their phones or stand in the street. In addition, the old sports ground is broken and dirty.

I would like to suggest repairing the sports ground and opening a small youth club in the empty building near the market.

I believe this would keep young people healthy and bring the community together.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,

Akmal Tursunov

UNIT 11 · OPINION

Should young people do volunteer work? Give reasons for your opinion.

In my opinion, young people should do some volunteer work.

Firstly, volunteering helps young people to gain experience. They can learn new skills and put this experience on their CV.

Secondly, they help people in need, for example, elderly neighbours or children in hospital. This makes them feel useful and happy.

Some people say students are too busy with their studies. However, even two hours a month can make a difference.

To sum up, I believe volunteer work is good for young people and for the whole community.

UNIT 12 · WRITING TASK

Review a film or series

Review: Spider-Man: No Way Home

I recently watched Spider-Man: No Way Home with my friends. It's an action film about Peter Parker, who asks a doctor to help him, but everything goes wrong.

What I liked most were the special effects – the fights look amazing on a big screen. The main actor's performance was also very good and the story was funny and moving.

On the other hand, the film is quite long and some parts were confusing if you haven't seen the other films.

I'd give it four stars out of five. It's well worth watching if you like superheroes!

UNIT 12 · OPINION

Is it better to watch films at home or at the cinema? Give your opinion.

In my opinion, it is better to watch new films at the cinema, but home is better for everyday watching.

Firstly, at the cinema the screen and sound are much better. Action films and cartoons are more exciting on a big screen.

Secondly, going to the cinema is a social activity. You can go with friends and talk about the film afterwards.

On the other hand, watching at home is cheaper and more comfortable, and you can pause the film.

To sum up, I go to the cinema for big films and watch other films at home.

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